

CHI HOA

THE RE-EDUCATION CAMPS I HAVE PASSED THROUGH

I. Curriculum Vitae:

- 1) Name: SOURCE, No AKA.
- 2) Date and place of birth: March 18, 1933 in Chau Hoa Village, Ben Tre Province.
- 3) Rank: Major. Serial No: SOURCE DATA
- 4) Occupation: Radio Navigator
- 5) Position: Assistant Officer at the Observation Bureau, Air Operation Headquarters (T.A.C.C.)
- 6) Duration of Service: From December 58, 1953 to April 50, 1975.
- 7) Duration of detention: From June 50, 1975 to April 50, 1982.

II. Names of the camps I have stayed in, with dates:

- A. 1) From June 50, 1975 to March 50, 1976.
 - 2) Place: Hoc Mon camp. HT.L19-T1.
 - 3) Description: Former South Vietnam Engineering and Construction Base, traditionally called Thanh Ong Nam, Mr. Nam's fort, situated on Highway 1 and about 15 kilometers North of Saigon, on the way to Tay Ninh.
 - 4) Camp Population: About 3000 people.
- B. 1) From March 50, 1976 to March 50, 1977.
 - 2) Place: Tan Hiep camp in Bien Hoa. HT 1248.
 - 3) Description: Formerly the "Tan Hiep prison for communist prisoners of war".

- 2 -

- 4) Location: On the right of Highway 1, in the direction of Bien Hoa towards Ho Nai, about 8 kilometers East of Bien Hoa airbase.
- 5) Camp population: 5 zones - K1, K2, K3, K4, K5, held about 5000 detainees. I was in K1.
- C. 1) Duration: From March 50, 1977 to November 54, 1977. HT 3127-A.
 - 2) Place: Bui Gia map camp (Dac O), 25km. Northwest of Phuoc Long town, close to Vietnam - Cambodia frontier.
 - 3) Camp population: 400 people.
- D. 1) Duration: From November 50, 1977 to April 50, 1978. HT 3127-A.
 - 2) Location: Harassed by Cambodian soldiers, the communists moved us to Bu Loi camp, situated on Road No. 10 joining Bu Dang district to Minh Hung, Phuoc Long province. This camp was about 9 km. away from Minh Hung.
 - 3) Camp Population: 400 people.
- E. 1) Duration: From April 50, 1978 to June 50, 1978. HT 3127-A.
 - 2) Place: Bau Bay map camp, South of Minh Hung village, on Highway 14 joining Saigon. Bu Dang - Ban Me Thuot.
 - 3) Camp Population: 380 people (excluding 8 who escaped successfully 1 who committed suicide, 1 who died of disease and 15 who had been released in Bu Loi).
- F. 1) Duration: From June 50, 1978 to October 50, 1978. HT 3127-A.
 - 2) Location: Minh Hung camp, 800 meters West of Minh Hung village, also on Highway 14.

51

58

- 3 -

3) Camp Population: 390 people.

G. 1) Duration: From October⁵⁰, 1978 to April⁵⁰, 1982.

2) Place: Tan Hiep camp in Bien Hoa. HT1248-K2.

3) Camp Population: 5000 people in 5Ks.

Remarks: * From June 15, 1975 to January 1, 1979, the Ministry of Defence (Northern Army) looked after us.

* From January 1, 1979 to April 5, 1982, the Northern Security Service, Ministry of Internal Affairs took over.

* On Christmas Eve of 1979, the whole camp population of 5000 detainees celebrated the occasion solemnly.

The security guards rushed in to take away 2 people in K1.

Uniformly, detainees from 5 Ks staged a non-violence struggle right in the camp compound, by sitting in line orderly, demanding the release of the two fellow detainees. The camp committee reluctantly obliged after 3 hours but many groups of 10 to 40 people each were later transferred to Chi Hoa prison and Cung Son prison in Tuy Hoa province, as a result of the camp committee's secret investigations.

* The Northern Army established a special military court in 1977 in Tan Hiep camp to pass sentence and execute publicly by firing squad Majors Be and Thinh, Intelligence and Military Security Officers of South Vietnam Army, who were recaptured during their escape attempts. One special procedure of the communist legislation is that a coffin is made available even prior to the trial during which a defendant has no right to defend himself and after which he will be blindfolded, gagged, tied up and shot on the spot.

- 4 -

* The communist re-education camps are sprouting up everywhere in the whole Vietnam territory despite their bragging of being a member of the United Nations. The camps exist in villages, districts, provinces, zones and in the Capital.

* Three individual detainees to be mentioned:

1) Captain Van, Intelligence Officer, escaped from his camp in a night of 1981. The camp committee remained puzzled about his disappearance as no trace whatsoever of how he managed to escape was found. Captain Van was in HT1248-K2-N13.

2) Navy Captain Loc went on hunger strike to object to being treated cruelly, treatment not conforming to that of the Geneva Agreement about prisoners of war. He belonged to HT1248-K2-N13. He was transferred to camp clinic K30 and died there in 1982.

3) A Catholic priest by the name of Thanh, about 70 years old was jailed in Chi Hoa prison in Saigon. He could not earn a release despite his ripe age and serious illness but was moved to clinic K30 instead. He remained here for a long time until his death on the 1st day of the lunar year of 1982. He was not shrouded until the 3rd day of the new year when his relatives were allowed to claim his corpse for burial.

59

60

Early 1982, clinic K30 was annexed to K2 as all the other Ks had been disassembled in order to build another better camp in Dong Hoa called Tong Le Chan camp in Binh Long province.

Above is what I witnessed and knew of. Apart from the possible time inaccuracy, I can guarantee that the facts were 100% authentic.

Written in Singapore

August 28, 1982

Source

LIST OF FELLOW DETAINEES WHOSE NAMES I CAN STILL RECALL

No.	Names	Ranks	Position	Released	Still in Detention	Foreigners	Remarks
1	Nguyen Viet Nhu	Colonel	Doctor, Operation Section Chief, Cong Hoa Military Hospital	-	Sent to Cong Son in 1980	-	-
2	Nguyen Khai	Colonel	Doctor, Cong Hoa Military Hospital	-	-ditto-	-	-
3	Nguyen Van Chau	Colonel	Deputy Commander, Military Medical Corps	-	To Chi Hoa prison, Saigon - 1980	-	-
4	Nguyen Van Phat	Colonel	Retired doctor from the Army	1981	-	-	Died 2 months after released, of illness
5	Nhut	Colonel	Quarter Master Department	-	To Cong Son, 1980	-	-
6	Nguyen Van Nhut	Lt. Col.	C130 Pilot of Division V, Air Force	1977	-	-	-
7	Nhut	Lt. Col.	Operation Center, Air Support II	1977	-	-	-
8	Nguyen Van Nhiep	Major	Doctor, Airborne	-	To Cong Son, 1980	-	-
9	Nguyen Duc Luon	Major	Assistant Bureau Chief of Discipline Bureau, Navy Headquarters	Feb. 12, 1980	-	-	Now in Singapore camp
10	Nguyen Ngoc Trung	Major	Military Inspector General, Joint General Staff	Jan. 1981	-	-	-ditto-
11	Nguyen Van Cho	Major	Administrative Officer, Signals Department	Mar. 1981	-	-	-
12	Nguyen Hau Dan	Captain	Officer of Bureau II, Binh Duong Sub-Sector	Oct. 1981	-	-	-
13	Truong Dinh Tung	Major	Logistic General Department	June 1981	-	-	Arrested for escape attempt in 1982; now in Singapore camp

(ii)

No.	Names	Ranks	Position	Released	Still in Detention	Foreigners	Remarks
14	Pham Huu Nha	Major	Chief of Cabinet, Medical Department	June 1981	-	-	-
15	Vu Dinh An	Major	Buddhist Veteran, Chaplain Marine Corps Division	Oct. 1981	-	-	-
16	Cao Van Sieng	Major	Ex-District Chief of Cai Lay, My Tho Province	Oct. 1981	-	-	-
17	Nguyen Chuong	Major	Logistics Battalion Commander, Division 22, Infantry	April 1982	-	-	-
18	Trinh Long	Major	Construction Engineering, Tactical Zone I	April 1982	-	-	-
19	Nguyen Van Hai	Major	Quang Trung Military Training Center	April 1982	-	-	-
20	Tran Van Loc	Major	Instructor, Division 5, Air Force	Dec. 1977	-	-	-
21	Hoang Huu He	Lt. Col.	Quarter Master	1980	-	-	These two officers were informants for the communists during their detention in camps
22	Hoang Mai Dong	1st Lt.	Political war, Khanh Hoa Sub-Sector	1980	-	-	-ditto-
23	Truong Van Dau	Lt. Col.	Chief of Cabinet, Lt. General Duong Van Ninh's Office	1981	-	-	Lt. Colonel Dau informed on the masterminds of the Christmast 79 incident.

(iii)

No.	Names	Ranks	Position	Released	Still in Detention	Foreigners	Remarks
24	Nguyen Van Phuc	Major	Battalion Commander, Division 18, Infantry	-	still detained	-	-
25	Tran Quan Liem	1st Lt.	Bureau II Officer, Binh Duong Sub-Sector	-	-ditto-	-	-
26	Lam Y	1st Lt.	AC 47 Pilot, Air Division 5	-	-ditto-	-	-
27	Nguyen Van Ngoc	2nd Lt.	Air Force Security	-	-ditto-	-	-
28	Nguyen Van Hiep	2nd Lt.	Marine Corps Officer	-	-ditto-	-	-
29	Thong Hung	1st Lt.	Khmer Army Officer, Lon Nol Regime	-	-ditto-	Khmer.	-
30	Nghe Hong Kin	Sergeant	Chinese, Owner of Coca Restaurant in Cholon	-	-ditto-	Chinese	-
31	Nguyen Van Mung	Civilian	Dissident, Hoa Hao Buddhist Sect	-	-ditto-	-	-
32	Tran Phat Thanh	1st Lt.	Dissident, arrested in Saigon	-	-ditto-	-	-
33	Quam Cat Tuong	Major	Ex-Military Security Section Chief in Kien Tuong Province	-	-	-	Died on the 3rd day of Lunar year of 1982 From No. 24 toward 33, all were sent to Dong Hoa camp (Tong Le Chan, Binh Long Province) in May 1982.

ALL INFORMATION GIVEN BELOW WILL BE TREATED IN CONFIDENCE.

PRISONER DATA QUESTIONNAIRE

DATE 22-35

NAME Source
(Block capitals; please underline surname or family name)

COUNTRY WHERE IMPRISONED VIETNAM

ADDRESS BEFORE ARREST Source DATA
HO CHI MINH CITY VIETNAM

FAMILY DETAILS, i.e. whether married, how many children and dependents, etc. Please give names, addresses and ages if possible.

NAME (WIFE) DATA SAN FRANCISCO CALIF
DATA 1944 (VIETNAM)

NAME (DAUGHTER) SAME ABOVE
DATA 1973 (VIETNAM)

DATE OF BIRTH, OR APPROXIMATE AGE DATA 1941 HAIPHONG (VIETNAM)

EDUCATION (names of schools and universities attended) LAW UNIVERSITY SAIGON

NHA TRANG NAVY OFFICER SCHOOL - VIETNAM

OCCUPATION LIEUTENANT COMMANDER Source DATA

PAST OCCUPATIONS SG BEN LUC NAVY CAMP VIETNAM

NATIONALITY (i.e. citizenship) VIETNAMESE

MINORITY GROUP N/A

RELIGION BUDDHIST

WHICH POLITICAL PARTY DOES HE/SHE BELONG TO OR SUPPORT THE REPUBLIC OF VIETNAMESE ARMFORCES

OTHER ORGANIZATIONS, e.g. TRADE UNIONS

DATE AND PLACE OF ARREST 06-16-1975 - SAIGON VIETNAM

LEGISLATION UNDER WHICH HELD DO NOT KNOW

PREVIOUS ARRESTS (if so, please give details) NONE

HAS HE/SHE BEEN CHARGED? DO NOT KNOW

TEXT OF CHARGE, OR REASON GIVEN BY GOVERNMENT FOR THE ARREST RE-EDUCATION

WHY DO YOU THINK THIS PERSON WAS ARRESTED? THE GOVERNMENT CHANGED HAND

HE WAS IN THE SOUTH VIETNAM NAVY

HAS HE/SHE SEEN FAMILY OR LAWYER SINCE ARREST? HE MET HIS WIFE AN HOUR ON JULY 1975 AT

VINH PHU CAMP (NORTH VIETNAM)

HAS HE/SHE BEEN TRIED? DO NOT KNOW

SENTENCE NONE

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE

JOINT CHIEFS OF STAFF
MESSAGE CENTER

VZCZCML1605111111

1011

ACTION

DIA:

OTSR

CJCS OJS JAT(14) JS(12) NMCC SECDEF(17) NMIC SECDEF:

ASD:ISA(11) :DJA(15)

- SECSTATE WASH DC

- C I A

- NSA CMC

- CSAF WASH DC

- CNO WASH DC

- CSA WASH DC

- PACS FILE(1)

(249)

TRANSIT/231532Z/231406Z/003:24JUN2361855

DE 00308 236184V

ZNY

P 231532Z AUG 75

FM

TO RUEKJCS/DIA WASHDC//DIADC//DIR2C//

RUEADWD/DA WASHDC//ADSI-ISA//DAMI-FII-E//

RUEHQUA/COMIPAC HONOLULU HI

BT

THIS IS JIP 2 221 2673 75

1. REPUBLIC OF KOREA (KS)/REPUBLIC OF VIET NAM (VS)/NORTH VIET NAM (VN)

2. INTER-AGENCY REPORT

3. D/A

4. MAY 75

5. SOURCE, 221 2673 75

6. D-A

7. SOURCE

8. 2 221 2673 75

9. 15 AUG 75

10. D/A

11. INITIATIVE: IPSE PG 2422

12. D/A 1 AUG 1975-76

13. LIT FOR F. LIT 221 2673 75

14. C. LIT 221 2673 75, 1, 2, 3

15. DETAILS:

16. THE STATUS OF THE REMAINING REPUBLIC OF KOREA (KS)

17. 1

171111

47

65

66